

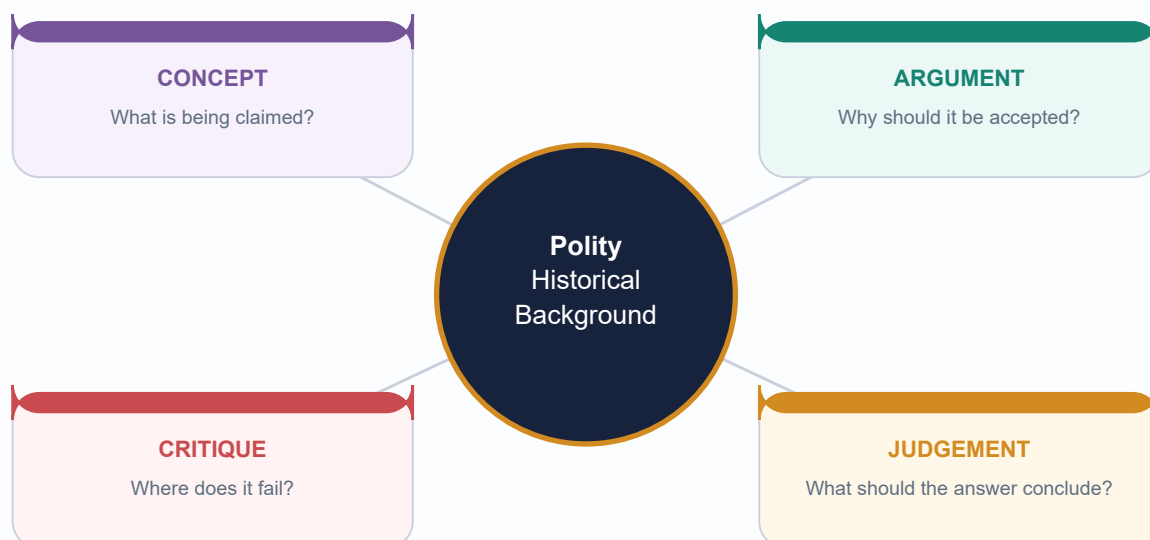
PREMIUM SOLVED WORKBOOK

Polity 01 - Historical Background: Solved Practice Workbook

Indian Polity Topic 01 | GS-I and GS-II | Rebuilt 14 August 2026

Repository Markdown first | local OCR sources second | no forced current affairs | Qdrant not used

Approval state: generated, approved=false



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

PYQ 1. 2018 Prelims GS-I Q38 - CROSS-OWNED by Modern History; relevant to Polity 01Prelims / GS-II
Solved practice**NEWS TRIGGER**

[FACT] Practice is source-routed. Exact PYQ wording is used only where the local official scan was read directly.

INTRO & ORIGIN

[ANALYSIS] Solve by identifying the constitutional device, operational status and closest distractor.

[LIMIT] Cross-owned items retain their true Modern History owner even when they are useful here.

STATIC THEORY

- In the Federation established by The Government of India Act of 1935, residuary powers were given to the: (a) Federal Legislature (b) Governor General (c) Provincial Legislature (d) Provincial Governors

- Correct option: B. [LIMIT] The official answer key is unavailable locally; this is INFERRED - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED, very high confidence. The Governor-General held the residuary allocation. [LIMIT] The federal scheme itself never commenced. The item is locally verified from the official scanned paper; the repository routing assigns true ownership to Modern Indian History Topic 24.

- Why this earns marks: The solution states the exact provision, eliminates the close distractor, preserves answer-key status and labels ownership.

MAINS ANGLE

Use mistakes to revise the provision -> significance -> limitation chain.

STUDY LINK

PYQ routing ledgers and
Polity/basic/Historical-Background.md

HIGH

PYQ 2. 2019 Prelims GS-I Q4 - CROSS-OWNED by Modern History; relevant to Polity 01Prelims / GS-II
Solved practice**NEWS TRIGGER**

[FACT] Practice is source-routed. Exact PYQ wording is used only where the local official scan was read directly.

INTRO & ORIGIN

[ANALYSIS] Solve by identifying the constitutional device, operational status and closest distractor.

[LIMIT] Cross-owned items retain their true Modern History owner even when they are useful here.

STATIC THEORY

- Consider the following statements about 'the Charter Act of 1813': 1. It ended the trade monopoly of the East India Company in India except for trade in tea and trade with China. 2. It asserted the sovereignty of the British Crown over the Indian territories held by the Company. 3. The revenues of India were now controlled by the British Parliament. Which of the statements given above are correct? (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

- Correct option: A. Statements 1 and 2 are correct; statement 3 overstates parliamentary revenue control. [LIMIT] The local official paper is verified, but the official answer key is unavailable locally; answer is INFERRED - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED, high confidence. True routing owner: Modern Indian History Topic 06.

- Why this earns marks: The solution states the exact provision, eliminates the close distractor, preserves answer-key status and labels ownership.

MAINS ANGLE

Use mistakes to revise the provision -> significance -> limitation chain.

STUDY LINK

PYQ routing ledgers and
Polity/basic/Historical-Background.md

HIGH

PYQ 3. 2023 Prelims GS-I Q50 - CROSS-OWNED by Modern History; relevant to Polity 01

Prelims / GS-II
Solved practice

NEWS TRIGGER

[FACT] Practice is source-routed. Exact PYQ wording is used only where the local official scan was read directly.

INTRO & ORIGIN

[ANALYSIS] Solve by identifying the constitutional device, operational status and closest distractor.

[LIMIT] Cross-owned items retain their true Modern History owner even when they are useful here.

STATIC THEORY

- By which one of the following Acts was the Governor General of Bengal designated as the Governor General of India? (a) The Regulating Act (b) The Pitt's India Act (c) The Charter Act of 1793 (d) The Charter Act of 1833

- Correct option: D. The Charter Act 1833 created the Governor-General of India; William Bentinck was first. [LIMIT] Local official paper verified; official key unavailable locally, so this is INFERRED - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED, very high confidence. True routing owner: Modern Indian History Topic 06.

- Why this earns marks: The solution states the exact provision, eliminates the close distractor, preserves answer-key status and labels ownership.

MAINS ANGLE

Use mistakes to revise the provision -> significance -> limitation chain.

STUDY LINK

PYQ routing ledgers and
Polity/basic/Historical-Background.md

HIGH

PYQ 4. 2024 Prelims GS-I Q62 - DIRECT owner Polity 01Prelims / GS-II
Solved practice**NEWS TRIGGER**

[FACT] Practice is source-routed. Exact PYQ wording is used only where the local official scan was read directly.

INTRO & ORIGIN

[ANALYSIS] Solve by identifying the constitutional device, operational status and closest distractor.

[LIMIT] Cross-owned items retain their true Modern History owner even when they are useful here.

STATIC THEORY

- With reference to the Government of India Act, 1935, consider the following statements: 1. It provided for the establishment of an All India Federation based on the union of the British Indian Provinces and Princely States. 2. Defence and Foreign Affairs were kept under the control of the federal legislature. Which of the statements given above is/are correct? (a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- Correct option: A. Statement 1 is correct as a provision even though the federation never commenced. Statement 2 is false because defence and foreign affairs were reserved under the Governor-General. The local official Set-A paper and official Set-A key are present and verified.

- Why this earns marks: The solution states the exact provision, eliminates the close distractor, preserves answer-key status and labels ownership.

MAINS ANGLE

Use mistakes to revise the provision -> significance -> limitation chain.

STUDY LINK

PYQ routing ledgers and
Polity/basic/Historical-Background.md

HIGH

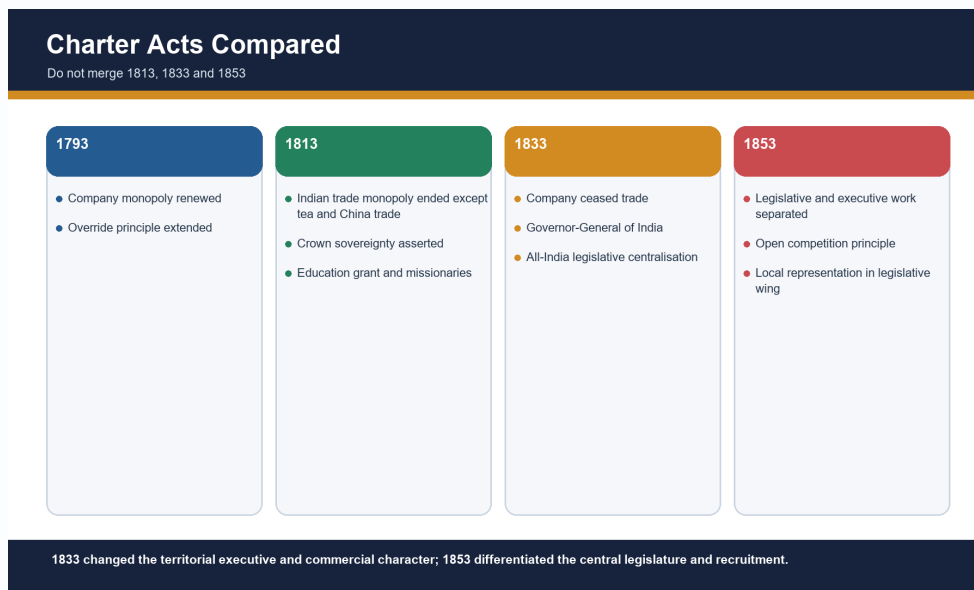
Broad MCQ set - 40 solved questionsPrelims / GS-II
Solved practice**NEWS TRIGGER**

[FACT] Practice is source-routed. Exact PYQ wording is used only where the local official scan was read directly.

INTRO & ORIGIN

[ANALYSIS] Solve by identifying the constitutional device, operational status and closest distractor.

[LIMIT] Cross-owned items retain their true Modern History owner even when they are useful here.

WORKBOOK REVISION VISUAL

Original topic schematic reused to anchor retrieval before practice.

Repository-generated instructional visual; not external artwork.

STATIC THEORY

- Q1. Which event supplied the Company with a durable fiscal base in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa?

- A. Diwani grant of 1765 | B. Charter of 1600 | C. Battle of Plassey alone | D. Government of India Act 1858

- Answer: A. Diwani joined revenue and civil authority to Company power.

- Q2. The Regulating Act 1773 created which office?

- A. Governor-General of India | B. Governor-General of Bengal | C. Viceroy of India | D. Secretary of State for India

- Answer: B. The all-India title dates to 1833.

- Q3. What was the central purpose of the Settlement Act 1781?

- A. Abolishing the Company | B. Introducing provincial autonomy | C. Clarifying Supreme Court jurisdiction and protecting official acts | D. Creating separate electorates

- Answer: C. It repaired executive-judicial and revenue-jurisdiction conflict.

- Q4. Under Pitt's India Act, political supervision was exercised through the:

- A. Court of Wards | B. Council of India | C. Federal Court | D. Board of Control

- Answer: D. The Court of Directors retained commercial administration.

- Q5. The Charter Act 1813 ended Company monopoly except:
 - A. Tea and trade with China | B. Salt and opium | C. Cotton and indigo | D. Shipping and insurance
- Answer: A. This exception is the recurring PYQ distinction.
- Q6. Which change belongs to the Charter Act 1833?
 - A. Company was abolished | B. Governor-General of Bengal became Governor-General of India | C. Provincial dyarchy began | D. Separate Muslim electorates began
- Answer: B. William Bentinck became first Governor-General of India.
- Q7. Which change most precisely belongs to 1853 rather than 1833?
 - A. End of Company trade | B. All-India legislative centralisation | C. Separation of legislative and executive work in the Governor-General's council | D. Creation of Governor-General of India
- Answer: C. 1853 differentiated the legislative wing and established open competition principle.
- Q8. The Government of India Act 1858 abolished:
 - A. Provincial legislatures | B. Governor-General's office | C. All civil services | D. Court of Directors and Board of Control
- Answer: D. The Company system ended and Crown control operated through Secretary of State.
- Q9. The 1861 Act associated Indians with law-making primarily through:
 - A. Nomination as non-official members | B. Universal election | C. Separate electorates | D. Cabinet responsibility
- Answer: A. Association was nominated and limited.
- Q10. The 1892 Act is best linked to:
 - A. Provincial autonomy | B. Budget discussion and questions to the executive | C. Federal Court | D. Abolition of official majority
- Answer: B. Scrutiny expanded without responsible government.
- Q11. The constitutional novelty of the 1909 Act was:
 - A. Provincial dyarchy | B. Three legislative lists | C. Separate electorates for Muslims | D. Universal adult franchise
- Answer: C. 1909 communal electorate; 1919 dyarchy; 1935 provincial autonomy.
- Q12. S.P. Sinha's appointment is associated with:
 - A. The Regulating Act | B. The 1919 statutory commission | C. The Independence Act | D. The 1909 reform era
- Answer: D. He became the first Indian member of the Viceroy's Executive Council.
- Q13. Under the 1919 system, education and public health were generally:
 - A. Transferred provincial subjects | B. Reserved federal subjects | C. Excluded subjects | D. Princely-state subjects
- Answer: A. Ministers handled transferred fields, though finance and override limited them.
- Q14. Which statement about the Simon Commission is correct?
 - A. It was elected by Indian provincial councils | B. All seven members were British | C. It created the Poona Pact | D. It commenced the 1935 federation
- Answer: B. Its exclusion of Indians drove the boycott.

- Q15. The Poona Pact replaced separate electorates for depressed classes with:
 - A. No representation | B. Universal adult franchise | C. Reserved seats in joint electorates | D. Nominated executive seats
- Answer: C. This distinction matters for the later constitutional model.
- Q16. Which feature of the 1935 Act actually operated?
 - A. All-India Federation | B. Dyarchy at the centre | C. Responsible federal cabinet | D. Provincial autonomy
- Answer: D. The federation and central dyarchy never commenced.
- Q17. Under the 1935 Act, residuary powers were associated with the:
 - A. Governor-General | B. Federal legislature | C. Provincial legislatures | D. Federal Court
- Answer: A. The 2018 PYQ tests this point.
- Q18. Defence and external affairs under the proposed 1935 central scheme were:
 - A. Controlled by the federal legislature | B. Reserved under the Governor-General | C. Transferred to provincial ministers | D. Placed under the Federal Court
- Answer: B. Hence statement 2 of the 2024 PYQ is incorrect.
- Q19. Which body began functioning in 1937?
 - A. Supreme Court of Calcutta | B. Central Public Service Commission | C. Federal Court | D. Board of Control
- Answer: C. The Federal Court was a major judicial predecessor.
- Q20. The Indian Independence Act caused British paramountcy over princely states to:
 - A. Transfer automatically to India | B. Transfer automatically to Pakistan | C. Continue until 1950 | D. Lapse
- Answer: D. Lapse created the political task of integration.
- Q21. Which Act first separated central and provincial subjects?
 - A. Government of India Act 1919 | B. Indian Councils Act 1892 | C. Indian Councils Act 1909 | D. Indian Independence Act 1947
- Answer: A. The 1919 division preceded the three-list scheme of 1935.
- Q22. Bicameralism in six provinces is associated with:
 - A. Regulating Act 1773 | B. Government of India Act 1935 | C. Indian Councils Act 1861 | D. Charter Act 1853
- Answer: B. The six were Bengal, Bombay, Madras, Bihar, Assam and United Provinces.
- Q23. Which is the best test of responsible government?
 - A. Presence of Indian nominees | B. Budget discussion alone | C. Executive removal through an elected legislature | D. A written statute
- Answer: C. Association and consultation do not equal political responsibility.
- Q24. The Court of Directors primarily retained which side after 1784?
 - A. Final imperial political supervision | B. Federal adjudication | C. Provincial cabinet responsibility | D. Commercial and Company administration
- Answer: D. Political supervision shifted to the Board of Control.

- Q25. Which Act recognised the portfolio system and restored provincial legislative powers?
- A. Indian Councils Act 1861 | B. Charter Act 1813 | C. Indian Councils Act 1909 | D. Government of India Act 1935
- Answer: A. It combined association with legislative decentralisation.
- Q26. The Central Public Service Commission was established in:
- A. 1854 | B. 1926 | C. 1909 | D. 1937
- Answer: B. The 1919 Act provided the institutional path.
- Q27. Which is a democratic rupture rather than colonial continuity?
- A. Office of Governor | B. Public Service Commission | C. Universal adult franchise | D. Three-list distribution
- Answer: C. The colonial franchise remained restricted.
- Q28. The most accurate description of colonial constitutionalism is:
- A. Full democracy under imperial rule | B. Absence of any legal institutions | C. Immediate federal sovereignty in 1935 | D. Rule through statutes and institutions without popular sovereignty
- Answer: D. Legalisation and institutionalisation did not equal self-government.
- Q29. Which statement best distinguishes a reserved seat from a separate electorate?
- A. A reserved seat can operate within a common electorate | B. They are always identical | C. A separate electorate uses no electoral roll | D. Reserved seats exclude community candidates
- Answer: A. The Poona Pact is the key example.
- Q30. Which Act removed the Company's remaining commercial character?
- A. Charter Act 1813 | B. Charter Act 1833 | C. Charter Act 1853 | D. Government of India Act 1858
- Answer: B. 1813 narrowed monopoly; 1833 ended trade; 1858 ended Company government.
- Q31. Which 1935 feature did not commence because princely-state accession conditions were unmet?
- A. Provincial autonomy | B. Federal Court | C. All-India Federation | D. Provincial elections
- Answer: C. Provided and operated must be kept distinct.
- Q32. Which is the best qualified continuity thesis?
- A. The Constitution copied 1935 unchanged | B. No colonial institution survived | C. Separate electorates were retained nationally | D. Administrative structures continued but democratic legitimacy and rights transformed them
- Answer: D. Continuity and rupture must both be stated.
- Q33. The 1781 Act instructed the Calcutta Supreme Court to apply:
- A. Personal law to Hindu and Muslim litigants in relevant matters | B. Only English criminal law in every dispute | C. The 1935 federal lists | D. Universal civil code
- Answer: A. This was part of jurisdictional clarification.
- Q34. The Charter Act 1853 extended Company government:
- A. For exactly twenty years | B. Without a fixed renewal period | C. Until 1947 by irrevocable grant | D. Only until the 1857 Revolt
- Answer: B. Parliament could terminate it at any time.

- Q35. Which sequence is correct?
- A. 1909 dyarchy; 1919 autonomy; 1935 electorate | B. 1909 autonomy; 1919 electorate; 1935 dyarchy in provinces | C. 1909 separate electorate; 1919 provincial dyarchy; 1935 provincial autonomy | D. 1909 federation; 1919 Crown rule; 1935 Diwani
- Answer: C. This is the core close-option sequence.
- Q36. What is the strongest limitation on calling 1892 responsible government?
- A. There were no Indians anywhere | B. No budget could be mentioned | C. The Company still governed India | D. The executive was not removable by the councils
- Answer: D. Official control and executive irresponsibility remained.
- Q37. The first Viceroy of India was:
- A. Lord Canning | B. Warren Hastings | C. William Bentinck | D. Lord Minto
- Answer: A. Canning became Crown representative after 1858.
- Q38. The phrase 'Governor-General of India' first belongs to:
- A. Regulating Act 1773 | B. Charter Act 1833 | C. Pitt's India Act 1784 | D. Charter Act 1793
- Answer: B. This was the exact 2023 Prelims demand.
- Q39. The proposed central dyarchy under 1935 would have divided:
- A. Provincial voters into rural and urban lists | B. Courts into civil and criminal branches | C. Federal subjects into reserved and transferred categories | D. Princely states into elected provinces
- Answer: C. It never operated.
- Q40. Which statement about the RBI is most precise?
- A. The 1935 Act alone was the RBI's constituting statute | B. The RBI began under the 1919 Act | C. The Federal Court created the RBI | D. It was created under the RBI Act 1934 and began in 1935 within the wider constitutional settlement
- Answer: D. Avoid the textbook shorthand that the 1935 Act itself created the RBI.

MAINS ANGLE

Use mistakes to revise the provision -> significance -> limitation chain.

STUDY LINK

PYQ routing ledgers and
[Polity/basic/Historical-Background.md](#)

HIGH

Remedial MCQ set - 8 solved questions

Prelims / GS-II
Solved practice

NEWS TRIGGER

[FACT] Practice is source-routed. Exact PYQ wording is used only where the local official scan was read directly.

INTRO & ORIGIN

[ANALYSIS] Solve by identifying the constitutional device, operational status and closest distractor.

[LIMIT] Cross-owned items retain their true Modern History owner even when they are useful here.

WORKBOOK REVISION VISUAL

Government of India Act 1935

Proposed federation, operating provincial autonomy and extensive safeguards

Federal scheme

- Provinces plus acceding princely states
- Three legislative lists
- Federation never commenced

Centre

- Dyarchy proposed
- Defence and external affairs reserved
- Central dyarchy never operated

Provinces

- Dyarchy abolished
- Provincial autonomy operated from 1937
- Governors retained special responsibilities

Institutions

- Federal Court
- Public Service Commissions
- RBI framework
- Bicameralism in six provinces

Provided for is not the same as commenced; provincial autonomy operated, the All-India Federation did not.

Original topic schematic reused to anchor retrieval before practice.

Repository-generated instructional visual; not external artwork.

STATIC THEORY

- Q1. The Regulating Act's executive title was:

- A. Governor-General of Bengal | B. Governor-General of India | C. Viceroy | D. Secretary of State

- Answer: A. 1773 versus 1833.

- Q2. The Company was abolished by:

- A. Charter Act 1853 | B. Government of India Act 1858 | C. Charter Act 1833 | D. Pitt's India Act

- Answer: B. 1853 changed council and recruitment, not sovereignty.

- Q3. Dyarchy in provinces belongs to:

- A. Councils Act 1909 | B. Government of India Act 1935 | C. Government of India Act 1919 | D. Independence Act 1947

- Answer: C. 1935 abolished provincial dyarchy.

- Q4. The 1935 federation:

- A. Operated from 1937 | B. Ended in 1939 after full implementation | C. Excluded princely states by design | D. Was provided for but never commenced

- Answer: D. Accession condition was unmet.

- Q5. Under 1909, representation for Muslims used:

- A. Separate electorates | B. Reserved seats in a universal joint electorate | C. Nomination only | D. No community classification

- Answer: A. Do not collapse electoral devices.

- Q6. The Poona Pact used:

- A. Separate electorates for depressed classes | B. Reserved seats in joint electorates | C. No reserved seats | D. A federal communal chamber

- Answer: B. It changed the Communal Award arrangement.

- Q7. The Court of Directors after 1784:

- A. Was abolished immediately | B. Became the Federal Court | C. Continued alongside the Board of Control | D. Controlled only provincial courts

- Answer: C. Dual control lasted until 1858.

- Q8. Provincial autonomy is associated with:

- A. Government of India Act 1919 | B. Councils Act 1892 | C. Charter Act 1813 | D. Government of India Act 1935

- Answer: D. 1919 equals provincial dyarchy.

MAINS ANGLE

Use mistakes to revise the provision -> significance -> limitation chain.

STUDY LINK

PYQ routing ledgers and
[Polity/basic/Historical-Background.md](#)

HIGH

Original solved Mains - 10, 15 and 20 marks

Prelims / GS-II
Solved practice

NEWS TRIGGER

[FACT] Practice is source-routed. Exact PYQ wording is used only where the local official scan was read directly.

INTRO & ORIGIN

[ANALYSIS] Solve by identifying the constitutional device, operational status and closest distractor.

[LIMIT] Cross-owned items retain their true Modern History owner even when they are useful here.

WORKBOOK REVISION VISUAL

Colonial Inheritance into 1950

Retained machinery, democratised principles, rejected devices

Retained and transformed

- Parliamentary procedure
- All-India services
- Federal lists
- Governor, courts and audit architecture

Constitutional rupture

- Popular sovereignty
- Universal adult franchise
- Fundamental Rights
- Independent Election Commission

Rejected

- Separate electorates
- Official majorities
- Imperial paramountcy
- Executive irresponsibility

Answer spine

- Claim
- Named Act or provision
- Significance
- Limitation
- Balanced verdict

The Constitution is structural continuity plus democratic and republican rupture, not simple copying.

Original topic schematic reused to anchor retrieval before practice.

Repository-generated instructional visual; not external artwork.

STATIC THEORY

- Question (10 marks): Examine how the Charter Acts transformed the East India Company from a commercial corporation into an administrative agency.

- Demand and thesis: [ANALYSIS] The Charter Acts progressively removed monopoly, trade and undifferentiated corporate government while centralising public administration.

- Claim -> named evidence: [FACT] The 1813 Act ended the Indian trade monopoly except tea and China trade; the 1833 Act ended Company trade, created the Governor-General of India and centralised legislation; the 1853 Act separated legislative and executive work and established open competition in principle.

- Significance: [ANALYSIS] Economic liberalisation and administrative centralisation were simultaneous: the Company lost commercial privilege as its bureaucracy and legislature became more state-like.

- Limitation / qualification: [LIMIT] The transformation remained colonial, racially unequal and politically irresponsible; 1853 did not transfer power to the Crown.

- Conclusion: [ANALYSIS] The Company ceased to be a trader before it ceased to be a ruler, making 1833 the commercial break and 1858 the sovereign transfer.

- Why this earns marks: It answers the directive directly, follows claim -> named provision/evidence -> significance -> limitation, and scales evidence to the mark demand. Use three to four named Acts or provisions.

- Question (15 marks): Analyse why dyarchy under the Government of India Act 1919 failed to create responsible provincial government.

- Demand and thesis: [ANALYSIS] Dyarchy failed because responsibility was divided by subject while fiscal and overriding authority remained concentrated in the Governor.
- Claim -> named evidence: [FACT] Transferred subjects such as education, health, agriculture and local government went to ministers answerable to councils; reserved subjects such as finance, police and land revenue remained with Governor and Executive Council. Restricted franchise, official safeguards and Governor override bounded councils.
- Significance: [ANALYSIS] Ministers bore public blame without controlling finance, coercion or the entire administrative chain; the split also obstructed coordinated policy.
- Limitation / qualification: [LIMIT] The experiment widened Indian executive experience and legislative debate, so it was not institutionally empty; however, participation is not the same as full responsibility.
- Conclusion: [ANALYSIS] Its structural mismatch explains why the 1935 Act abolished provincial dyarchy and introduced provincial autonomy, though safeguards still survived.
- Why this earns marks: It answers the directive directly, follows claim -> named provision/evidence -> significance -> limitation, and scales evidence to the mark demand. Use six to seven named Acts or provisions.
- Question (20 marks): The Constitution is both a culmination of colonial constitutional development and a repudiation of colonial rule. Discuss.
- Demand and thesis: [ANALYSIS] The Constitution inherited administrative forms but replaced their imperial source, restricted representation and executive irresponsibility with popular sovereignty, rights and universal franchise.
- Claim -> named evidence: [FACT] 1773 and 1833 built central executive-legislative machinery; 1853 developed legislative differentiation and merit recruitment; 1861 and 1892 introduced portfolio government and scrutiny; 1919 separated subjects and created a PSC path; 1935 supplied lists, Governors, provincial autonomy, Federal Court and PSCs; 1947 made the Assembly sovereign.
- Significance: [ANALYSIS] These provisions explain institutional continuity in federal distribution, courts, services and legislative procedure, while rejection of separate electorates, official majorities and restricted franchise marks democratic rupture.
- Limitation / qualification: [LIMIT] Colonial safeguards, communal electorates and executive dominance were not inherited as normative principles; nor were Fundamental Rights, universal adult franchise or constitutional remedies gifts of colonial statutes.
- Conclusion: [ANALYSIS] Thus 1950 was not a blank slate or a copy: it constitutionalised inherited machinery within a republican, rights-based and electorally sovereign order.
- Why this earns marks: It answers the directive directly, follows claim -> named provision/evidence -> significance -> limitation, and scales evidence to the mark demand. Use eight to ten named Acts or provisions plus comparison.
- Question (10 marks): Trace the evolution of legislative control over the executive from 1861 to 1935.
- Demand and thesis: [ANALYSIS] Legislative control evolved from nominated association to scrutiny and limited responsibility, but full executive accountability was withheld.
- Claim -> named evidence: [FACT] The 1861 Act nominated non-official Indians; 1892 allowed budget discussion and questions; 1909 enlarged councils and elections while retaining central official control; 1919 introduced bicameralism, direct elections and provincial ministers; 1935 created provincial responsible ministries subject to safeguards.
- Significance: [ANALYSIS] Each stage added a technique of parliamentary government - representation, questions, budget debate or ministerial responsibility.
- Limitation / qualification: [LIMIT] Official majorities, restricted franchises, Governor-General vetoes and gubernatorial safeguards prevented sovereignty from shifting to legislatures.
- Conclusion: [ANALYSIS] The Constitution completed the trajectory by making executives collectively responsible to legislatures elected through universal adult franchise.

- Why this earns marks: It answers the directive directly, follows claim -> named provision/evidence -> significance -> limitation, and scales evidence to the mark demand. Use three to four named Acts or provisions.
- Question (15 marks): Critically examine the claim that the Government of India Act 1935 established a federation in India.
- Demand and thesis: [ANALYSIS] The Act designed a federation but did not establish an operating All-India Federation.
- Claim -> named evidence: [FACT] It proposed provinces plus acceding princely states, Federal, Provincial and Concurrent Lists, a federal legislature, central dyarchy and a Federal Court. Accession conditions were not met; defence and external affairs remained reserved and residuary authority lay with Governor-General. Provincial autonomy and the Federal Court did operate from 1937.
- Significance: [ANALYSIS] The design became an important federal-administrative source for the Constitution and rehearsed inter-governmental distribution.
- Limitation / qualification: [LIMIT] Its princely component, central dyarchy and imperial safeguards prevented democratic federal responsibility, and its principal federal part never commenced.
- Conclusion: [ANALYSIS] The precise verdict is designed federation, operating provincial autonomy and judicial institutions, but no functioning All-India Federation.
- Why this earns marks: It answers the directive directly, follows claim -> named provision/evidence -> significance -> limitation, and scales evidence to the mark demand. Use six to seven named Acts or provisions.
- Question (20 marks): Assess how colonial electoral reforms shaped and distorted representation in India.
- Demand and thesis: [ANALYSIS] Colonial reforms widened representation while fragmenting it through restricted, indirect and communal devices designed to preserve imperial control.
- Claim -> named evidence: [FACT] 1861 used nomination; 1892 used recommendation-based indirect election; 1909 created separate Muslim electorates; 1919 extended separate electorates and direct election under limited franchise; the 1932 Award extended communal representation; the Poona Pact replaced depressed-class separate electorates with reserved seats in joint electorates; 1935 widened but retained qualified franchise.
- Significance: [ANALYSIS] The reforms developed electoral procedure and legislative politics, yet privileged community categories and elites while withholding universal political equality.
- Limitation / qualification: [LIMIT] Community claims were not merely manufactured by Britain, but imperial design institutionalised and strategically managed them. Representation did not make the executive fully responsible.
- Conclusion: [ANALYSIS] The Constitution retained reservations within joint electorates for SC/ST but rejected separate electorates and restricted franchise through universal adult suffrage.
- Why this earns marks: It answers the directive directly, follows claim -> named provision/evidence -> significance -> limitation, and scales evidence to the mark demand. Use eight to ten named Acts or provisions plus comparison.
- Question (10 marks): Explain the civil-service trajectory from Company patronage to constitutional public service commissions.
- Demand and thesis: [ANALYSIS] Recruitment moved from Company patronage toward competitive and institutionally protected public service, though colonial racial barriers persisted.
- Claim -> named evidence: [FACT] The 1833 Act articulated an opening principle but Court of Directors resistance frustrated it; the 1853 Act established open competition and the 1854 Macaulay Committee followed; the 1919 settlement provided for a Public Service Commission, established centrally in 1926; the 1935 Act provided federal, provincial and joint commissions.
- Significance: [ANALYSIS] Merit recruitment and commission insulation became institutional ancestors of Articles 315-323.
- Limitation / qualification: [LIMIT] Competition did not create equality in practice, and services remained instruments of imperial administration.

- Conclusion: [ANALYSIS] The Constitution retained merit and commission architecture while subordinating services to equality, legislative government and constitutional accountability.
- Why this earns marks: It answers the directive directly, follows claim -> named provision/evidence -> significance -> limitation, and scales evidence to the mark demand. Use three to four named Acts or provisions.
- Question (15 marks): Colonial constitutionalism developed legality without democracy. Analyse.
- Demand and thesis: [ANALYSIS] British rule increasingly used statutes, councils, courts and procedures, but sovereignty and decisive executive power remained imperial.
- Claim -> named evidence: [FACT] 1773 regulated the Company and created a Supreme Court; 1784 formalised supervision; 1833 centralised law-making; 1861-1892 created councils and scrutiny; 1909-1919 widened elections; 1935 designed autonomy and federation. Yet official majorities, restricted franchise, separate electorates, reserved subjects, vetoes and safeguards persisted.
- Significance: [ANALYSIS] Legality regularised administration and produced institutions later democratised, but it also legitimised and stabilised colonial extraction and control.
- Limitation / qualification: [LIMIT] Indian political pressure widened concessions, so the story is not unilateral imperial design; nor were institutions meaningless simply because they were colonial.
- Conclusion: [ANALYSIS] The Constitution's achievement was to detach legal institutions from imperial sovereignty and ground them in the people, rights and responsible government.
- Why this earns marks: It answers the directive directly, follows claim -> named provision/evidence -> significance -> limitation, and scales evidence to the mark demand. Use six to seven named Acts or provisions.
- Question (20 marks): Compare the constitutional significance of the Acts of 1919 and 1935.
- Demand and thesis: [ANALYSIS] The 1919 Act initiated limited provincial responsibility; the 1935 Act replaced provincial dyarchy with autonomy and designed a wider federal structure.
- Claim -> named evidence: [FACT] 1919 separated central/provincial subjects, split provincial fields into reserved/transferred, created central bicameralism, direct elections, expanded communal electorates and a PSC path. 1935 created three lists, provincial autonomy, proposed central dyarchy and federation, bicameralism in six provinces, Federal Court and multiple PSCs, with extensive safeguards.
- Significance: [ANALYSIS] The second Act responded to the failure of divided provincial responsibility and supplied more of the institutional vocabulary later used in 1950.
- Limitation / qualification: [LIMIT] Neither created popular sovereignty: franchise remained restricted, Governors retained special powers, and the 1935 federation and central dyarchy never commenced.
- Conclusion: [ANALYSIS] 1919 was the experiment in limited responsibility; 1935 was the comprehensive but safeguarded federal-administrative blueprint.
- Why this earns marks: It answers the directive directly, follows claim -> named provision/evidence -> significance -> limitation, and scales evidence to the mark demand. Use eight to ten named Acts or provisions plus comparison.

MAINS ANGLE

Use mistakes to revise the provision -> significance -> limitation chain.

STUDY LINK

PYQ routing ledgers and
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